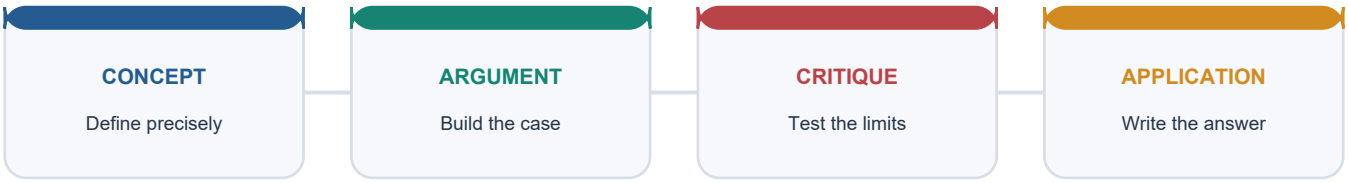
COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Indian Legal and Institutional Architecture - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved Practice Workbook

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Workbook Contents

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. A district collector needs statutory authority - not mere administrative custom - to assign prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery duties across three tiers of government. Which instrument supplies that authority?

A. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. B. The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. C. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. D. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. - the DM Act, 2005 is the parent statute that creates the national/state/district authorities and assigns the five functions themselves; it is the source of the tiered mandate the scenario asks for, not a later fund, enabling section or 2025 insertion.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. - section 46 funds relief and response expenditure; it does not create the three-tier authority structure the scenario asks about.
- **Option C (incorrect):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - section 41A only permits an optional additional city-level authority; it presupposes the Act's tiered structure rather than creating it.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - these 2025-inserted committees add crisis-coordination bodies; they do not establish the base national/state/district tiers.

Trap: Do not credit a later amendment, fund section or committee insertion with creating the foundational tiered structure that the parent 2005 Act itself establishes.

Q2. Which of the following is NOT one of the five functions the DM Act, 2005 assigns to its authorities?

A. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. B. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. C. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. D. NIDM is the statutory nodal institute for human-resource development, capacity building, training, research, documentation and policy advocacy.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. - this option correctly restates the five functions themselves, so it is consistent with - not an exception to - the Act's assignment.
- **Option B (correct):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - statutory crisis-committee status for the NCMC and HLC was inserted only in 2025 and is a coordination/command layer, not one of the Act's original five functions (prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response, recovery).

- **Option C (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - specialist response capacity is the operational arm carrying out the 'response' function; it does not name a function outside the five.
- **Option D (incorrect):** NIDM is the statutory nodal institute for human-resource development, capacity building, training, research, documentation and policy advocacy. - capacity-building and training support the 'preparedness' function; it does not name a function outside the five.

Trap: Do not mistake a body that operationalises one of the five functions (force, institute) for a sixth function; the trap option must name something genuinely outside prevention/mitigation/preparedness/response/recovery.

Q3. A state government official argues the 2005 Act is complete on its own and needs no reading against any later text. Which fact directly disproves that claim?

A. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. B. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. C. The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. D. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - this describes SDMA's state-level policy role and says nothing about whether the 2005 Act text is current.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - this describes SEC's coordination role and is irrelevant to whether the 2005 Act needs to be read with a later amendment.
- **Option C (correct):** The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. - the Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 - assented 29 March 2025, in force 9 April 2025 - is the precise dated fact proving the 2005 text is not the current, complete position.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. - this describes local-authority functions and does not address the currency of the 2005 statutory text.

Trap: Do not accept an institutional definition as a substitute for the specific dated amendment fact the question demands.

Q4. An answer states 'the Act only assigns response and recovery functions.' Which fact corrects this understatement?

A. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. B. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. C. The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition. D. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - this names the district-tier authority and chair, not the full function list the correction requires.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - this names the coordinating committee and its chair, not the function list itself.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition. - this concerns which plan edition is current (2016 vs 2019), not the Act's function list.
- **Option D (correct):** The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. - the Act assigns five functions - prevention, mitigation and preparedness in addition to response and recovery - so 'only response and recovery' understates its scope; this is the correcting fact.

Trap: Do not let a chair/authority fact substitute for the specific function-list correction the question is testing.

Q5. A candidate must cite the exact date the 2025 amendment became operative law (not merely when it received assent). Which date is correct?

A. The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. B. The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition. C. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. D. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. - the fact states both dates precisely: assent on 29 March 2025 and commencement (came into force) on 9 April 2025 - the commencement date is the one the question demands.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition. - this concerns the 2016/2019 plan editions, an unrelated dated fact.
- **Option C (incorrect):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - this states sections were 'inserted in 2025' without the specific assent/commencement date pair the question needs.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - this concerns Section 41A's enabling power, not the amendment's own commencement date.

Trap: Do not conflate assent date with commencement date, or substitute an unrelated 2025-linked fact for the specific dated amendment status.

Q6. Sections 8A, 8B and 41A were all inserted by the same amendment exercise. Which statement correctly describes what Section 41A itself enables (as distinct from 8A/8B)?

A. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. B. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. C. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. D. The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - this describes Sections 8A/8B (crisis committees), a different pair of inserted sections from 41A.
- **Option B (correct):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - Section 41A specifically enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification - an enabling, not automatic, city-level power distinct from the crisis-committee sections.

- **Option C (incorrect):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - this describes Section 44A (State response force), a different inserted section from 41A.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. - this states the amendment's overall dates but does not describe what Section 41A specifically enables.

Trap: Do not merge the distinct enabling sections (8A/8B for crisis committees, 41A for urban authority, 44A for state force) into one another.

Q7. Which section, inserted by the 2025 amendment, empowers a state to raise its own specialist disaster response force, separate from the SDRF fund?

A. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. B. The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. C. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. D. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - this names the national force (NDRF), not the state-level force the 2025 section creates.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. - this names the national response fund under section 46, an unrelated national-fund provision.
- **Option C (correct):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - Section 44A is the amendment-inserted provision enabling a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force, and the fact explicitly warns against confusing it with the SDRF fund.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - this names the State Executive Committee's coordination role, not a force-creating section.

Trap: Do not answer with the national-level NDRF force/fund pair when the question specifically asks about the 2025-inserted state-level enabling section.

Q8. A statement claims: 'because Section 41A exists, every eligible city now has a functioning Urban Disaster Management Authority.' Which fact shows this inference is unsafe?

A. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. B. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. C. The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. D. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - this is the general mandate-outcome principle; it is a valid supporting idea but not the specific fact naming Section 41A's own non-automatic status.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - this describes the

NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local policy cascade, not the urban-authority enabling provision.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. - this only states the amendment's commencement date and does not address whether cities have actually constituted the authority.
- **Option D (correct):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - the fact itself states the statutory permission under Section 41A 'does not prove constitution in every eligible city' - directly rebutting the claim that the enabling power guarantees universal implementation.

Trap: Do not accept the general mandate-outcome firewall as a full substitute when a more specific, on-point fact (Section 41A's own wording) directly answers the question.

Q9. A news report describes an authority 'chaired by the Prime Minister' that issues national disaster policies and guidelines. Which body is this?

A. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. B. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. C. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. D. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - NDMA is specifically the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines under the Act - matching the chair and function described.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - NEC is chaired by the Union Home Secretary, not the Prime Minister, so the chair identity rules this out.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA is chaired by the Chief Minister at the state level, not the Prime Minister at the apex.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - these are 2025-inserted crisis-coordination committees, distinct from the policy-issuing apex authority chaired by the PM.

Trap: Do not select a body on the basis of 'national-level' alone; the Prime Minister-specific chair is the decisive identifying fact.

Q10. Which of the following is NOT a function NDMA exercises under the Act?

A. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. B. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. C. The amended architecture assigns National and State Plan preparation to NDMA and SDMA, while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring roles. D. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - this restates NDMA's own policy/plan/guideline function, so it is a function NDMA does exercise, not an exception.
- **Option B (correct):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - coordinating and monitoring state-level implementation is the State Executive Committee's role (chaired by the Chief Secretary), not something NDMA itself does - making this the correct 'NOT a function of NDMA' answer.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The amended architecture assigns National and State Plan preparation to NDMA and SDMA, while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring roles. - this confirms NDMA's assigned role in National Plan preparation, again a function it does exercise.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - these are separate 2025-inserted committees; naming them does not describe a function wrongly attributed to NDMA.

Trap: Do not pick an option merely because it names a different institution; the correct 'NOT NDMA' answer must be a function genuinely exercised by that other institution, not by NDMA.

Q11. An aspirant conflates NDMA's policy-setting role with NEC's coordination role in an answer. Which fact is the exact firewall needed to correct this?

A. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. B. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. C. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. D. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - restating NDMA's own role does not by itself draw the firewall against NEC; the question needs the contrasting NEC fact.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the cascade describes the NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local policy chain, not the specific NDMA-versus-NEC distinction at the apex.
- **Option C (correct):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - stating precisely that NEC - chaired by the Union Home Secretary - coordinates, monitors and implements policy is the fact needed to separate NEC's implementation role from NDMA's policy-setting role.
- **Option D (incorrect):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the general mandate-outcome firewall is about proof of outcomes, not about separating NDMA's policy role from NEC's coordination role.

Trap: Do not answer a chair/mandate-confusion question with the general outcome-proof firewall; match the specific contrasting institutional fact instead.

Q12. In the federal cascade (apex to local), which institution occupies the top rung that NDMA is being tested against here?

A. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. B. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. C. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. D. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA is the state-tier rung, chaired by the Chief Minister, below the apex rung.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - DDMA is the district-tier rung, chaired by the District Collector/Magistrate, below both the apex and state rungs.

- **Option C (incorrect):** Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. - Panchayats/municipalities occupy the closest-to-ground rung, the lowest tier in the cascade.
- **Option D (correct):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority - the top rung of the NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade referenced by the question.

Trap: Do not select a lower cascade tier merely because it also 'lays down' or 'approves' something at its own level; only the Prime Minister-chaired body sits at the apex rung.

Q13. A press note describes a body 'chaired by the Union Home Secretary' that coordinates and monitors implementation of national disaster policy. Which body is this?

A. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. B. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. C. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. D. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - the National Executive Committee is precisely the Union Home Secretary-chaired body that coordinates, monitors and implements national policy and plans - matching the chair given.
- **Option B (incorrect):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - NDMA is chaired by the Prime Minister and sets policy; it is not the Union Home Secretary-chaired coordinating body described.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - SEC is chaired by the Chief Secretary at the state level, a different tier and chair from the Union Home Secretary.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - DDMA is chaired by the District Collector/Magistrate at the district level, not the Union Home Secretary at the Union level.

Trap: Do not confuse the Union Home Secretary-chaired NEC with the Chief Secretary-chaired SEC merely because both are 'executive committees.'

Q14. Which pair below is most at risk of being wrongly merged in an answer, per this topic's own examiner caution?

A. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. B. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. C. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. D. The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - restating NEC's own definition does not identify the specific confusion pair the caution warns against.
- **Option B (correct):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - the examiner caution attached to NEC's own session specifically warns: do not merge NDRF-the-force with NDRF-the-fund - so the force/fund pair is the one this

concept flags as the standard confusion risk.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA's definition is unrelated to the force/fund confusion pair flagged in this session's caution.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition. - the plan-edition fact (2016 vs 2019) is a different confusion risk, not the one attached to this concept.

Trap: Do not assume every session's caution is about its own named institution; some captions (like NEC's) flag a different pair (NDRF force vs fund) as the live confusion risk.

Q15. A Mains answer says 'NEC approves state disaster policy.' Which fact shows this duty actually belongs elsewhere?

A. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. B. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. C. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. D. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - restating NEC's actual (national coordination) role does not by itself show where the state-policy duty really sits.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - SEC coordinates state-level implementation but does not itself lay down or approve state policy; it is a distractor, not the answer.
- **Option C (correct):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - it is SDMA, chaired by the Chief Minister, that lays down state policy and approves the State Plan - not NEC, so this is the fact exposing the misattribution.
- **Option D (incorrect):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the general mandate-outcome firewall does not identify which specific body approves state policy.

Trap: Do not accept 'Committee' or 'Executive' naming similarity as proof of shared function across NEC, SEC and SDMA; each has a distinct chair and mandate.

Q16. Which function below is exercised at the Union level by an executive committee (as opposed to an apex, PM-chaired authority)?

A. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. B. Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. C. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. D. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - NDMA is the PM-chaired apex authority itself, the opposite of the 'executive committee' category the question asks for.
- **Option B (incorrect):** Sections 8A and 8B inserted in 2025 give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee. - these are separate 2025-inserted crisis committees, not the standing coordinating executive committee at the Union level.

- **Option C (incorrect):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - Section 41A concerns an optional city-level authority, not a Union-level executive committee.
- **Option D (correct):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - NEC's coordination/monitoring/implementation of national policy and plans is exercised by an executive committee (Union Home Secretary-chaired), distinct from the PM-chaired apex authority (NDMA).

Trap: Do not equate 'committee' in the name with the specific Union-level coordinating role; NCMC/HLC are crisis-specific bodies, not the standing NEC.

Q17. A state cabinet note requires approval from the body 'chaired by the Chief Minister' before a State Plan can be finalised. Which body must approve it?

A. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. B. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. C. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. D. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA is chaired by the Chief Minister and is the body that lays down state policy and approves the State Plan - the exact approval authority the scenario names.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - SEC is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates implementation; it does not itself approve the State Plan.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - DDMA operates at the district tier, chaired by the District Collector/Magistrate, below the state-level approval sought here.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - NEC is a Union-level coordinating committee chaired by the Union Home Secretary, not a state-level approving authority.

Trap: Do not confuse the Chief Minister-chaired SDMA (policy/plan approval) with the Chief Secretary-chaired SEC (implementation coordination) at the same state tier.

Q18. Which caution applies specifically when writing about SDMA's own institutional architecture, per this topic's session material?

A. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. B. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. C. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. D. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - restating SDMA's own definition does not name the specific confusion risk the caution addresses.
- **Option B (correct):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - the SDMA session's own caution is: do not merge State Disaster Response Force with State Disaster Response Fund - this force/fund pair is the specific confusion

risk flagged for this concept.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - DDMA's chair/role is a different institution from the force/fund pair the caution is about.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the federal cascade is a separate concept from the state force/fund naming confusion flagged here.

Trap: Do not assume the caution attached to a concept always restates that concept's own definition; check whether it flags an adjacent force/fund naming trap instead.

Q19. Which statement correctly shows how the state tier adapts national direction, as this topic's material frames it?

A. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. B. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. C. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. D. Finance Commission awards and Central-State assistance shape disaster financing, but allocation, release, expenditure and verified outcome are separate evidence rungs.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - this describes the apex, national-level authority itself, not how the state tier adapts that direction.
- **Option B (incorrect):** Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. - this describes the local-authority tier, one level below the state tier the question asks about.
- **Option C (correct):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA - chaired by the Chief Minister, laying down state policy and approving the State Plan - is precisely how the state tier adapts and operationalises national direction under the Act.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Finance Commission awards and Central-State assistance shape disaster financing, but allocation, release, expenditure and verified outcome are separate evidence rungs. - this concerns Finance Commission financing, an unrelated axis from state policy adaptation.

Trap: Do not answer a tier-adaptation question with the apex authority's own definition; the question specifically wants the state-tier response.

Q20. A district officer wrongly seeks 'SDMA approval' for a District Plan. Which fact shows the correct approving authority instead?

A. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. B. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. C. The amended architecture assigns National and State Plan preparation to NDMA and SDMA, while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring roles. D. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA approves the State Plan, one tier above the District Plan the scenario is about.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - SEC coordinates state-level implementation; it neither prepares nor approves the District Plan.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The amended architecture assigns National and State Plan preparation to NDMA and SDMA, while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring roles. - this describes National/State Plan responsibility (NDMA/SDMA), not the District Plan tier the scenario asks about.
- **Option D (correct):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - the District Plan is prepared by DDMA (chaired by the District Collector/Magistrate, with the local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson) - DDMA, not SDMA, is the correct authority at that tier.

Trap: Do not let 'plan approval' generically point to SDMA; match the specific tier (district vs state) named in the scenario to the correct authority.

Q21. Which body is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan?

A. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. B. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. C. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. D. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - this two-chair structure (District Collector/Magistrate plus elected local-authority Co-Chairperson) and the District Plan-preparation duty are DDMA's specific, distinguishing features.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA is chaired solely by the Chief Minister at the state tier and approves the State Plan, not the District Plan.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - SEC is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates state implementation; it has no Co-Chairperson structure.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. - Panchayats/municipalities are the local-authority tier represented on DDMA, not DDMA itself.

Trap: Do not overlook the Co-Chairperson detail; a body with only a single chair cannot be DDMA, whose defining feature is the dual District Collector/Co-Chairperson structure.

Q22. An answer wrongly calls NIDM 'the operational response force at district level.' Which fact is the exact firewall against this error?

A. NIDM is the statutory nodal institute for human-resource development, capacity building, training, research, documentation and policy advocacy. B. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. C. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. D. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** NIDM is the statutory nodal institute for human-resource development, capacity building, training, research, documentation and policy advocacy. - restating NIDM's actual (training/research) mandate is useful, but it does not by itself supply the specific caution phrase this concept flags.
- **Option B (correct):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - the DDMA session's own caution is 'do not call NIDM an operational response force' - pairing DDMA's operational-planning

role against NIDM's separate capacity-building identity is the specific firewall the question demands.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - NDRF is the actual operational response force; naming it does not correct the NIDM misattribution being tested.
- **Option D (incorrect):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the general mandate-outcome firewall is a broader principle, not the specific DDMA-session caution about NIDM.

Trap: Do not substitute the general mandate-outcome firewall for the specific, on-point caution this concept's own session states about NIDM.

Q23. Which institutions together perform district-and-below operational planning and closest-to-ground functions, per the DDMA session's own mechanism chain?

A. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. B. The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. C. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. D. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - this restates DDMA itself, the first link in the chain, not the second (local-authority) link the question asks for.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Executive Committee is chaired by the Chief Secretary and coordinates and monitors state-level implementation. - SEC is a state-tier coordinating body, not part of the district-and-below mechanism chain.
- **Option C (correct):** Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. - the DDMA session's mechanism chain is 'DDMA -> Local authorities': Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform the closest-to-population preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions below DDMA.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - the urban authority under Section 41A is a separate, optional city-level body, not the standard DDMA-to-local chain.

Trap: Do not stop at DDMA alone when the question asks for the full district-to-local mechanism chain; the chain's second link (local authorities) is the specific answer required.

Q24. A textbook wrongly states 'DDMA is a purely advisory body with no plan-preparation duty.' Which fact directly refutes this?

A. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. B. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. C. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. D. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities perform assigned preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. - this describes local authorities' functions, not DDMA's own plan-preparation duty being defended here.
- **Option B (incorrect):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - this concerns the state response force under Section

44A, unrelated to DDMA's advisory-versus-statutory status.

- **Option C (incorrect):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the cascade describes cross-tier distribution generally; it does not specifically refute the 'DDMA is advisory' claim.
- **Option D (correct):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - DDMA's own definition explicitly assigns it the duty to prepare the District Plan - a concrete statutory duty, directly refuting the claim that it is 'purely advisory.'

Trap: Do not accept a general cascade or local-authority fact as a substitute for DDMA's own specific, named statutory duty (District Plan preparation).

Q25. Official material states this force 'has expanded to 16 battalions' under the Act. Which body does this describe?

A. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. B. The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. C. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. D. NIDM is the statutory nodal institute for human-resource development, capacity building, training, research, documentation and policy advocacy.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - the National Disaster Response Force is the specialist response force whose official material states the 16-battalion expansion - the exact body named in the scenario.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. - the National Disaster Response Fund (section 46) finances relief and response; it has no 'battalions' and is institutionally distinct from the force.
- **Option C (incorrect):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - the State Disaster Response Force (Section 44A) is a state-raised force, a different body from the national NDRF referenced here.
- **Option D (incorrect):** NIDM is the statutory nodal institute for human-resource development, capacity building, training, research, documentation and policy advocacy. - NIDM is a training/research institute, not an operational battalion-strength force.

Trap: Do not answer a battalion-strength / operational-force question with the identically abbreviated fund, or with a state-level or training institution.

Q26. Which of the following is institutionally distinct from the NDRF force despite sharing its abbreviation?

A. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. B. The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. C. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. D. The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - this is the force itself, not the distinct-but-identically-abbreviated body the question asks to identify.

- **Option B (correct):** The National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 finances eligible response and relief needs and is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force. - the National Disaster Response Fund under section 46 is explicitly stated to be 'institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated response force' - the precise same-abbreviation confusion the question tests.
- **Option C (incorrect):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - the state force shares no abbreviation clash with 'NDRF'; the specific same-initials confusion is with the fund, not this state body.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The National Executive Committee is chaired by the Union Home Secretary and coordinates, monitors and implements national disaster-management policy and plans. - NEC shares no abbreviation with NDRF at all, so it is irrelevant to this specific naming-confusion question.

Trap: Do not pick any 'similar-sounding' body in general; the question specifically tests the NDRF-force-versus-NDRF-fund same-abbreviation trap.

Q27. A state wants to raise its own specialist force rather than rely solely on the Union-level force. Which section and body applies?

A. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. B. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. C. Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. D. Sections 46, 47 and 48 contemplate national, state and district response and mitigation funds; statutory provision does not establish that every district fund is operational.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - this is the Union-level force itself, not the state-raised alternative the scenario asks about.
- **Option B (incorrect):** Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification; the statutory permission does not prove constitution in every eligible city. - Section 41A concerns an urban disaster management authority, not a state response force.
- **Option C (correct):** Section 44A enables a State Government to constitute a specialist State Disaster Response Force; this force must not be confused with the SDRF fund. - Section 44A specifically enables a State Government to constitute its own specialist State Disaster Response Force, distinct from both the Union-level NDRF force and the SDRF fund.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Sections 46, 47 and 48 contemplate national, state and district response and mitigation funds; statutory provision does not establish that every district fund is operational. - sections 46-48 concern response and mitigation funds, not the force-raising power under Section 44A.

Trap: Do not answer a state-force-creation question with the Union-level NDRF or an unrelated funds/urban-authority section.

Q28. Which statement about the NDRF force avoids overstating its evidentiary status?

A. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. B. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. C. The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. D. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the general mandate-outcome firewall is a valid principle but does not itself describe the NDRF force's specific status.

- **Option B (incorrect):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the federal cascade concerns policy authorities (NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local), not the NDRF force specifically.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. - the amendment's commencement date says nothing about the NDRF force's own operational description.
- **Option D (correct):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - describing NDRF strictly as 'a specialist response force under the Act' whose official material states a 16-battalion expansion is a properly sourced, non-speculative statement of its own status.

Trap: Do not substitute a general principle or an unrelated dated fact for the NDRF force's own specific, sourced description when asked to describe it precisely.

Q29. Which statement best captures how policy, coordination and implementation are distributed across the Act's federal tiers?

A. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. B. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. C. The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. D. The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition.

Answer: A. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (correct):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade fact directly states the distribution of policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels - the precise mechanism the question asks to identify.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The Disaster Management Act, 2005 establishes national, state and district authorities and assigns prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. - this states the Act's structure and functions generally, not the specific cross-tier distribution mechanism (the cascade) the question targets.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 received assent on 29 March 2025 and came into force on 9 April 2025; the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. - the amendment's commencement date is unrelated to how tiers distribute policy and implementation.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 is the latest published national plan and must be distinguished from the first 2016 edition. - the 2016-versus-2019 plan-edition fact is about plan currency, not the cross-tier cascade mechanism.

Trap: Do not answer a cascade/distribution question with a general Act-structure or dated-status fact; the cascade itself is the specific mechanism required.

Q30. A candidate claims 'an NDMA guideline alone proves that district-level capacity exists.' Which fact refutes this specific claim?

A. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. B. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. C. NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. D. The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan.

Answer: B. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the general

mandate-outcome firewall is a valid related principle but is a broader statement, not the specific cascade-level refutation asked for here.

- **Option B (correct):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the cascade fact itself states 'an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity' - this is the precise, on-point refutation of the claim in the question.
- **Option C (incorrect):** NDMA is the Prime Minister-chaired apex authority that lays down policies, plans and guidelines and exercises statutory functions under the Act. - restating NDMA's own definition does not by itself refute the claim about proving district capacity.
- **Option D (incorrect):** The District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan. - restating DDMA's own definition does not by itself supply the refuting logic; the cascade's own qualifying clause is what is required.

Trap: Do not substitute the general mandate-outcome firewall when the question specifically quotes the cascade concept's own qualifying clause.

Q31. Which principle applies generally across statutes, authorities, plans, forces, funds and notifications - not only within the NDMA-SDMA-DDMA cascade?

A. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. B. The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. C. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. D. Finance Commission awards and Central-State assistance shape disaster financing, but allocation, release, expenditure and verified outcome are separate evidence rungs.

Answer: C. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade distributes policy, coordination and implementation across federal levels; an apex guideline does not itself prove local capacity. - the cascade is the specific NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local mechanism, narrower than the general cross-cutting principle the question asks for.
- **Option B (incorrect):** The State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister and lays down state policy and approves the State Plan. - SDMA's own definition is a single-institution fact, not the general cross-cutting principle.
- **Option C (correct):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the mandate-outcome firewall is explicitly general: a statute, authority, plan, force, fund or notification mandate proves only its legal/institutional rung, with operational readiness and outcomes needing separate evidence - a principle broader than the cascade alone.
- **Option D (incorrect):** Finance Commission awards and Central-State assistance shape disaster financing, but allocation, release, expenditure and verified outcome are separate evidence rungs. - the Finance Commission funding fact is one specific application area, not the general principle itself.

Trap: Do not confuse the specific federal cascade (an authority-tier mechanism) with the broader mandate-outcome firewall (a general evidentiary principle applicable to any instrument type).

Q32. Which fact should be cited to avoid the standard UPSC close-option trap of treating a plan, fund or force's mere existence as proof of a completed outcome?

A. The amended architecture assigns National and State Plan preparation to NDMA and SDMA, while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring roles. B. Sections 46, 47 and 48 contemplate national, state and district response and mitigation funds; statutory provision does not establish that every district fund is operational. C. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. D. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence.

Answer: D. Option-by-option explanation:

- **Option A (incorrect):** The amended architecture assigns National and State Plan preparation to NDMA and SDMA, while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring roles. - this names which body prepares which plan; it does not itself state the general existence-versus-outcome firewall.
- **Option B (incorrect):** Sections 46, 47 and 48 contemplate national, state and district response and mitigation funds; statutory provision does not establish that every district fund is operational. - this states which sections create funds; it is one instance the firewall applies to, not the firewall statement itself.
- **Option C (incorrect):** The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist response force under the Act; official NDRF material states that it has expanded to 16 battalions. - this describes the NDRF force's own status; it is again an instance the firewall could apply to, not the firewall itself.
- **Option D (correct):** A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. - the mandate-outcome firewall is the general citable principle: mandate (statute/authority/plan/force/fund/notification) proves only the legal or institutional rung, not operational readiness or disaster outcomes.

Trap: Do not cite a specific institutional or fund fact as if it were the general firewall principle; the general principle must be stated in its own terms to close this trap correctly.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ROUTING

The 2020 GS-III question is directly owned here. The 2020 GS-II question is cross-cutting, while the 2024 urban-flood question uses this topic only for its institutional limb and remains primarily an urban-flooding question. No verified 2026 UPSC Prelims or Mains question routes directly to this topic.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-III

Demand: Discuss how the Government's proactive disaster-management approach replaced the earlier reactive strategy.

Status: Verified direct routing: Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words.

Demand decoding: 'Discuss' demands a two-sided narrative - trace the institutional shift the DM Act made possible, then weigh it against evidence of real implementation, rather than simply listing bodies.

Model answer (206 words): India's disaster-management approach shifted from a reactive, relief-only posture to a proactive one when the Disaster Management Act, 2005 created a statutory prevention-mitigation-preparedness-response-recovery cycle instead of leaving action to post-disaster relief alone. Institutionally, the Prime Minister-chaired NDMA now lays down anticipatory policies, plans and guidelines, while the Union Home Secretary-led NEC coordinates and monitors their implementation before, not only after, a disaster strikes. States mirror this shift through the Chief Minister-chaired SDMA (state policy and State Plan approval) and the Chief Secretary-led SEC (implementation coordination), and DDMA extends planning to the district, pairing the District Collector/Magistrate with an elected local-authority Co-Chairperson. The specialist National Disaster Response Force - expanded to 16 battalions on official record - gives the system standing operational capacity rather than ad hoc mobilisation. Planning itself is treated as a living exercise: the National Disaster Management Plan was revised in 2019, superseding its 2016 predecessor, reflecting continuous proactive updating. However, this institutional shift is a legal and planning shift, not an automatic outcome guarantee: an apex guideline, force or fund only fixes the mandate; whether local capacity, expenditure and preparedness are actually realised must be separately verified at the district and local-body level before the 'reactive to proactive' claim is treated as complete.

Executable answer plan: Open with the Act's five-function cycle as the pivot from reactive relief to proactive planning (2-3 lines); sequence NDMA-NEC-SDMA-SEC-DDMA plus NDRF capacity as the operational engine (8-10 lines); close by qualifying that mandate is not outcome (2-3 lines).

Why this earns marks: Names the pivoting statute, all five tiers with correct chairs, the force's battalion fact and the 2016-to-2019 plan revision - the specific evidence a 'discuss' answer on this exact demand is graded on.

How to improve: Add one district-level example (a specific State's DDMA or SDRF notification) to convert the closing qualification from a general caution into a concrete, evidenced local-capacity check.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2020 GS-II

Demand: Elucidate centralising tendencies through disaster-management legislation and other contemporary legislation.

Status: Verified cross-cutting routing: Elucidate · 15 marks · 250 words; this card addresses only the disaster-law and federal-balance limb.

Demand decoding: 'Elucidate' requires explaining the mechanism of centralisation with named provisions, not merely asserting that it exists; the routed 'disaster-law limb only' status also means the answer must not overreach into the other contemporary legislation this card does not own.

Model answer (197 words): Within its own federal-balance limb, disaster-management legislation shows a mild centralising tendency alongside its formally federal design. The Disaster Management Act creates a four-tier cascade - NDMA, NEC, SDMA/SEC and DDMA - but the apex, Prime Minister-chaired NDMA sets national policy and guidelines that states and districts are structured to follow, giving the Union a strong agenda-setting role even though SDMA formally approves its own State Plan. The 2025 amendment reinforces this: Sections 8A and 8B give statutory, Union-anchored status to the National Crisis Management Committee and High Level Committee, both apex bodies. At the same time, the amendment also devolves some capacity downward - Section 41A lets states notify their own Urban Disaster Management Authority, and Section 44A lets states raise their own specialist State Disaster Response Force - so centralisation is partial, not absolute. The clearer centralising signal is financial: Sections 46-48 route response and mitigation funds through a Union-anchored fund architecture, and Finance Commission awards and Central-State assistance shape the financing envelope that states depend on. Within this narrow legal limb, therefore, the tendency is towards Union-set policy and Union-shaped finance operating over a nominally decentralised institutional cascade, rather than towards outright unitary control.

Executable answer plan: State the routing limb upfront (1-2 lines); explain the NDMA-apex-policy mechanism (4-5 lines); balance it against the 2025 amendment's devolving sections 41A/44A (4-5 lines); close on the financial centralising signal via sections 46-48 and Finance Commission awards (3-4 lines).

Why this earns marks: Cites specific sections (8A/8B, 41A, 44A, 46-48) rather than a generic 'centre is powerful' claim, and explicitly balances centralising against devolving provisions as the demand requires.

How to improve: If attempting the full PYQ rather than this routed limb, add the 'other contemporary legislation' comparator explicitly, since this card certifies only the disaster-law strand.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-III

Demand: Discuss policies and frameworks for tackling urban flooding.

Status: Conservative cross-topic application of the verified 2024 Q18 demand; primary ownership remains Topic 08. No distinct word/mark limit is separately verified for this cross-topic card, so the model below follows the standard GS-III 15-mark/250-word Mains convention rather than a fabricated topic-specific figure.

Demand decoding: 'Discuss' invites a multi-dimensional answer; this topic can honestly supply only the legal/institutional dimension (Section 41A urban authority, DDMA/local role, plan currency, fund architecture) and must flag, not hide, that the drainage/urban-planning dimension belongs to Topic 08.

Model answer (174 words): For this urban-flooding question, the present topic supplies only the disaster-management-law limb; hydrology and urban-planning analysis must be added from the urban-flooding topic. Within this limb, Section 41A of the amended DM Act lets a State Government notify a dedicated Urban Disaster Management Authority, formally distinguishing city-specific flood governance from the ordinary district-based DDMA. The District Disaster Management Authority and local Panchayats/municipalities remain the default response and recovery layer, pending such urban-specific notification. Planning currency also matters: the revised National Disaster Management Plan, 2019 (superseding the 2016 edition) is the latest published national reference framework such answers should cite, not the earlier edition. Financing routes through Sections 46-48's national, state and district response and mitigation funds and Finance Commission awards, but a fund's statutory existence does not itself prove it is operational for a given city's flood response. Any complete answer must add Topic 08's specific urban-hydrology and infrastructure content; this card only certifies the disaster-law limb and does not claim full ownership of the demand.

Executable answer plan: State the routing limit upfront (1 line); explain Section 41A's urban authority and its relationship to DDMA (4-5 lines); cite the 2019 plan and Sections 46-48 fund caveat (4-5 lines); close by naming the missing Topic-08 dimension explicitly (2 lines).

Why this earns marks: Correctly scopes the answer to what this topic can verify (Section 41A, DDMA, 2019 plan, fund sections) instead of inventing hydrology/drainage content this topic does not own.

How to improve: Merge with Topic 08's urban-hydrology material before using this in a full mock answer; used alone, it under-answers a genuinely multi-topic GS-III demand.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish NDMA, NEC, SDMA, SEC and DDMA by composition and mandate. Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: 'Distinguish' needs a pairwise chair-and-mandate contrast for all five named bodies, not a merged descriptive list.

Model answer (145 words): India's disaster-management architecture separates policy-setting from execution at each tier. At the apex, NDMA is chaired by the Prime Minister and lays down national policies, plans and guidelines; the National Executive Committee (NEC), chaired by the Union Home Secretary, coordinates, monitors and implements that policy - composition and function both differ from NDMA. At the state level, SDMA, chaired by the Chief Minister, lays down state policy and approves the State Plan, while the State Executive Committee (SEC), chaired by the Chief Secretary, coordinates and monitors implementation - mirroring the NDMA-NEC split one tier down. At the district level, DDMA is chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate, with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, and prepares the District Plan, fusing policy and execution at that tier. The consistent distinction across all five bodies is chair, tier and whether the mandate is policy-setting or coordinating/implementing.

Executable answer plan: Pair NDMA/NEC and SDMA/SEC as two policy-versus-execution couplets (6-7 lines), then place DDMA as the district tier that fuses both roles (2-3 lines); close with the one-line unifying distinction (chair/tier/mandate-type).

Why this earns marks: Names all five chairs correctly and states the specific policy-versus-execution split the question tests, rather than a generic institutional list.

How to improve: Add the 2025 urban-authority and state-response-force sections (41A/44A) as a one-line extension showing the cascade is not limited to these five bodies.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Differentiate NDRF-the-force from disaster-response and mitigation funds. Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: 'Differentiate' requires the force-versus-fund contrast at both the national and state level, using the same-abbreviation confusion as the organising thread.

Model answer (129 words): NDRF and the response/mitigation funds share initials but not institutions. The National Disaster Response Force is a specialist operational force under the Act, officially stated to have expanded to 16 battalions - it exists to physically respond to disasters. The National Disaster Response Fund, under Section 46, is a separate financial instrument that finances eligible response and relief expenditure; it is institutionally distinct from the identically abbreviated force. States mirror both limbs: Section 44A lets a state raise its own specialist State Disaster Response Force, which must not be confused with the separate State Disaster Response Fund. Sections 46-48 together contemplate national, state and district response and mitigation funds, but the statutory provision for a fund does not itself prove that every district fund is actually operational or spent.

Executable answer plan: Open with the shared-abbreviation trap (1-2 lines); contrast NDRF force vs fund (4-5 lines); mirror at state level via 44A (3-4 lines); close on the funds-do-not-equal-operational-spend caveat (2 lines).

Why this earns marks: Explicitly separates force from fund at both national and state tiers and flags the operational-versus-statutory-existence gap, which is the precise distinction being tested.

How to improve: Cite the specific district-level fund (Section 48) explicitly alongside 46/47 to show the full three-tier fund architecture, not just the national pair.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain the significance and limits of the Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: 'Explain the significance and limits' is two-part - a positive institutional-upgrade case and an equally weighted enabling-versus-automatic caveat - both parts must be present.

Model answer (199 words): The Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 - assented 29 March 2025, in force 9 April 2025 - is significant because it converts several previously ad hoc arrangements into statutory ones. Sections 8A and 8B give statutory status to the National Crisis Management Committee and the High Level Committee, formalising apex crisis-coordination bodies that earlier operated without a dedicated legal basis. Section 41A enables a State Government to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority by notification, recognising that urban disaster risk needed a dedicated city-level authority distinct from the district-based DDMA. Section 44A similarly enables a state-raised specialist State Disaster Response Force, reducing dependence on the Union-level NDRF for routine state response. The amendment also clarifies that National and State Plan preparation stays with NDMA and SDMA while executive committees retain implementation and monitoring, tightening the policy-versus-execution boundary.

The limits are equally real: each of these is an enabling, not a mandatory, provision - 'may constitute' does not mean every state or eligible city has actually notified the authority or force. As with any statutory mandate, the amendment fixes the legal and institutional rung only; operational readiness, staffing, funding and outcomes require separate, State-specific verification before being claimed as achieved.

Executable answer plan: Cover the three statutory upgrades (8A/8B, 41A, 44A) with the policy/execution clarification as significance (10-12 lines); dedicate a distinct closing paragraph to the enabling-not-mandatory limit (3-4 lines).

Why this earns marks: Names the exact inserted sections and dates for the significance half, and states the enabling-versus-automatic distinction explicitly for the limits half, matching both demands of the question.

How to improve: Add one State-specific example of an actually-notified Urban DMA or SDRF (where verifiable) to convert the general 'may constitute' caveat into concrete evidence.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Analyse district and local capacity as the weak link in India's disaster-management cascade. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: 'Analyse... as the weak link' requires identifying the specific structural reasons (staffing, budget, training-versus-force confusion, fund non-operationality) the district/local tier is weaker, not just asserting weakness.

Model answer (201 words): The Disaster Management Act creates a clean cascade on paper - NDMA sets national policy, SDMA adapts it to the state, and DDMA, chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate with the elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, is meant to translate it into an operational District Plan. Panchayats, municipalities and other local authorities then carry out the preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. The structural risk is that this final, ground-level link is also the thinnest: DDMA and local bodies typically have the least technical staff, the smallest independent budgets, and the least frequent capacity-building exposure compared with NDMA, SDMA or the specialist NDRF/SDRF forces. NIDM's statutory mandate covers training, research and capacity building, but training capacity is not the same as an operational response force, and this topic's own material explicitly cautions against calling NIDM an operational response force. Because Sections 46-48 only contemplate district funds without guaranteeing every one is operational, district-level finance can lag district-level responsibility. The cascade is therefore only as strong as its weakest, most local rung; verifying DDMA staffing, plan currency, local-authority coordination and actual (not merely sanctioned) district fund utilisation is essential before treating the cascade as uniformly capable.

Executable answer plan: State the cascade design (2-3 lines); give the staffing/budget/training reasons for the weak link (6-8 lines); use the NIDM-versus-force caution as a named evidence point (2-3 lines); close on the fund-verification test (2-3 lines).

Why this earns marks: Gives concrete structural reasons (staffing, NIDM-vs-force confusion, district fund non-operationality) rather than a generic 'local capacity is low' assertion.

How to improve: Add a specific district-level statistic or case (where independently verifiable) on DDMA staffing or fund utilisation to convert the structural argument into an evidenced one.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate India's legal, planning and financial architecture for proactive disaster risk reduction. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: 'Evaluate' requires a balanced verdict - crediting the architecture's design while explicitly weighing it against implementation evidence, not a purely descriptive account.

Model answer (185 words): The Disaster Management Act, 2005 gives India a comprehensive proactive-DRR architecture by creating a national-state-district statutory cascade and assigning each tier prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery functions. The Prime Minister-chaired NDMA lays down national policies, plans and guidelines under the Act, while the Union Home Secretary-led NEC coordinates, monitors and implements them. States mirror this design through the Chief Minister-chaired SDMA, which approves the State Plan, and the Chief Secretary-led SEC, which drives state-level implementation. Planning is periodically refreshed: the National Disaster Management Plan was revised in 2019, superseding the first 2016 edition. Sections 46-48 contemplate National, State and District Response and Mitigation Funds, and Finance Commission awards with Central-State assistance shape the financing envelope; a statutory fund provision does not itself establish operational release or expenditure. The NDMA-SDMA-DDMA-local cascade carries policy down to the district, but an apex guideline alone does not prove local implementation capacity. India's legal, planning and financial architecture is comprehensive and layered for proactive risk reduction, but its real strength depends on verified fund utilisation and district-level readiness, not merely on the existence of law, plans and apex guidelines.

Executable answer plan: Describe the tiered legal/institutional design (6-7 lines); add the planning-currency and fund-architecture evidence (4-5 lines); close with the evaluative verdict tying design strength to verified implementation (3-4 lines).

Why this earns marks: Delivers an explicit evaluative verdict (design is comprehensive but implementation-dependent) rather than stopping at description, which is what 'evaluate' specifically demands.

How to improve: Add one named State or district instance of verified (or unverified) fund utilisation to move the closing evaluation from principle to evidence.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine federal coordination in disaster management while separating statutory mandate from operational outcome. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: 'Examine... while separating mandate from outcome' is an explicit instruction to keep two categories distinct throughout - legal/institutional mandate versus operational/outcome evidence - not merely to describe the cascade.

Model answer (207 words): Federal coordination in disaster management rests on a four-tier statutory cascade under the Disaster Management Act, as amended by the Disaster Management (Amendment) Act, 2025 (assented 29 March 2025, in force from 9 April 2025) - the current position is not the unamended 2005 text. The Prime Minister-chaired NDMA sets national policy, plans and guidelines, operationalised by the Union Home Secretary-led NEC. States replicate this through the Chief Minister-chaired SDMA and the Chief Secretary-led SEC, which lay down and coordinate state policy. The District Disaster Management Authority, chaired by the District Collector or Magistrate with an elected local-authority representative as Co-Chairperson, prepares the District Plan, and Panchayats and municipalities execute preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery functions closest to the affected population. Finance Commission awards and Central-State assistance shape the funding envelope, but allocation, release, expenditure and verified outcome remain evidence rungs distinct from the sanctioned mandate. A statute, authority, plan, force, fund, notification or database mandate proves its legal or institutional rung only; operational readiness and disaster outcomes require separate evidence. Genuine federal coordination therefore means tracing the cascade from Union mandate through state and district planning down to verified local capacity and expenditure, rather than treating an apex law or authority as proof of ground-level performance.

Executable answer plan: Trace the four-tier cascade with chairs and dates as the mandate half (8-9 lines); state the finance-envelope facts (2-3 lines); close with the explicit mandate-versus-outcome separation the question demands (3-4 lines).

Why this earns marks: Maintains the mandate-versus-outcome separation explicitly through the cascade description and the closing line, directly answering the question's own instruction rather than treating it as incidental.

How to improve: Add one instance where mandate existed but a verified outcome gap was reported (where independently confirmed) to evidence the separation rather than stating it as a general principle only.